

UPSC Philosophy Optional Paper 1 Simulation

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The paper has two sections, A and B, and eight questions.
2. Question 1 and Question 5 are compulsory.
3. Answer three other questions, choosing at least one from each section.
4. Answer five questions in all. The marks carried by each subpart are indicated.

SECTION A - Socio-Political Philosophy

Q1 (COMPULSORY)

- (a) "Complete liberty may lead to inequality while order and restrictions imply a necessary loss of freedom." Critically discuss. [10 marks]
- (b) "Nationalisation is not socialisation." Comment. [10 marks]
- (c) Can gender equality be realised within a socialist regime? Analyse. [10 marks]
- (d) Present a brief account of origin and development of Social Contract Theory. [10 marks]
- (e) "Genocide is simply mass murder on a large scale." Comment. [10 marks]

Q2

- (a) "Formal equality is either empty or ideological." Assess this claim with reference to Mill and Marx. [20 marks]
- (b) "An un-interfered-with dependant is nevertheless unfree." Critically discuss this claim and its consequences for the relation between law and liberty. [15 marks]
- (c) "The anarchist and the Marxist agree about domination and disagree about the state." Critically examine. [15 marks]

Q3

- (a) "Every ideology in this clause is stronger as a diagnosis than as a remedy." Discuss with reference to anarchism, Marxism and socialism. [20 marks]
- (b) Consider critically that gender discrimination is a rather man-made concept but not naturally endowed. [15 marks]
- (c) "The state may remove hindrances to freedom, but it may not define what freedom is for." Critically examine this claim with reference to the idealist and welfare-liberal accounts of the individual-state relation. [15 marks]

Q4

- (a) "Women is too internally divided a category to serve as the subject of a theory of gender justice." Critically discuss. [20 marks]
- (b) Do you think that retributive theory of punishment is against human rights? Discuss. [15 marks]
- (c) Critically evaluate the concepts of liberty and equality as political ideals. [15 marks]

SECTION B - Philosophy of Religion

Q5 (COMPULSORY)

- (a) Discuss the nature of God as propounded in Nyaya philosophy. [10 marks]
- (b) "Non-theistic is not identical with atheistic." Examine the significance of this distinction for the possibility of religion without God. [10 marks]

- (c) Distinguish between the transcendence and the immanence of God, and explain why classical theism must assert both. [10 marks]
- (d) Distinguish between alethic and soteriological religious pluralism, and state one consequence of the distinction. (Answer in about 150 words.) [10 marks]
- (e) Elucidate the personalistic and impersonalistic aspects of God. [10 marks]

Q6

- (a) Is the ontological proof for the existence of God by St. Anselm logical? Discuss. [20 marks]
- (b) Critically examine the claim that the divine attributes form a single package whose members constrain one another. [15 marks]
- (c) Does the diversity of mystical experience weaken its claim to disclose an objective transcendent reality? Critically examine. [15 marks]

Q7

- (a) "Every Indian conception of liberation is determined by its account of bondage." Examine this thesis across the major schools, and state what follows for the means of liberation. [20 marks]
- (b) Do analogy and symbol clarify religious language, or merely protect it from verification? Critically examine. [15 marks]
- (c) Examine the claim that personal identity, rather than immortality, is the real philosophical issue in the survival debate. Illustrate with both Western and Indian material. [15 marks]

Q8

- (a) Critically examine the arguments of Nyaya for the existence of God. [20 marks]
- (b) Present an exposition of ontological proof for the existence of God along with its criticism. [15 marks]
- (c) What proofs do Nyaya philosophers offer for the existence of God? Discuss. [15 marks]

END OF PAPER